

Vozes sem Corpo - RUN

Compiled table document. Source files remain authoritative. Rebuild this file

when reviewed prep changes. This is preparation, not session history.

Runtime header

Field	Value
System	SWADE Fifth Printing (2023)
Rank	Novice
Players	1
PC mode	player-supplied (Lilly Dawson)
Active setting modules	none
Supernatural level	subtle presentation; no supernatural truth
Historical accuracy	cinematic late-January 1986 texture; fictional Ashgrove
House rules	HR-NFA-001, HR-NFA-002
Expected runtime	3–5 hours
Compilation date	2026-09-19
Verified by	Final co-GM source review; QUALITY 108/120; Coherence passed; Grounding audit passed (36/36)

Not a scene script. Jump to the situation on the table: SP1 KCRK 102.3 FM; SP2 Records; SP3 Town Witnesses (Daisy’s / West End Fuel); SP4 Town Hall public works; SP5 Tower Compound; SP6 Disposition.

Payload lives in the named story point or lookup. First 15 minutes and Climax situation are indexes only.

Table terms

Term	Means
Original	A source reel, recorder track, paper log, or machine state with documentable custody; copies remain useful but may be challenged.
Synchronization gap	The same precise interval absent from independent records. It proves common process, not motive, culprit, or ownership.
Cleanup step	After the crew is alerted, one category Cal/Ray destroys or moves at the compound: paper log, signal head, Frank's body, then escape. Alert starts the clock but does not itself erase a category.
Protected evidence	Any item, copy, testimony, or notation Lilly has already secured; later failure does not retroactively erase it.

Notation

Rule	This adventure
First NPC / named creature mention	ALL-CAPS on first mention in each situation, then title case
Trait tests	Notice (–2), Persuasion, Electronics; no invented skills
Information rolls	Fail, success, and raise are always stated
Quoted speech	Table cues in Spoken lines ; not a script
Handouts	Reference inline (Handout A); full list in Handouts index. Cut the investigation packet before play; do not dump it at once.
GM Note	Secret; never player-facing
Optional material	Labeled Optional; never gates the objective
PC-specific hooks	Labeled PC hook — Lilly; never the only vector
Wild Card / Extra	Every prepared opponent block is labeled

Opening mood

The night never stopped; morning merely replaced fog with cold rain and paperwork. An ordinary local recording is already becoming somebody else's property. Ashgrove's lack of anonymity favors Lilly,

while every formal question risks warning the crew. At the tower, alert turns knowledge into a choice about what can still be preserved.

First 15 minutes

- [] **Play:** Story Point 1 — KCRK 102.3 FM.
- [] **Handed:** Abigail's fresh call from the previous night, Lilly's notebook (**Handout A**), badge, issue gear, and the still-shelved Loman file.
- [] **Cut before play:** investigation packet handouts/print/investigation-evidence.pt.pdf — six pieces (**Handouts B–G**). Give only what she obtains. The Water Authority sheet stays English-as-found.
- [] **Where they are:** arriving at KCRK (south of the river, Bridge Street continuation) on the wet morning after session 1. From 14 Cedar or Town Hall this is a short drive across the Bridge Street bridge, not a walk to the inland compound.
- [] **Trouble already in motion:** a purported engineer is asking for the original reel and is ready to leave.
- [] **First decision:** assert custody, copy first, question him, or let him go and follow.
- [] **If this block overruns:** omit arrival color and begin with Ray reaching for the reel case.

Mission in 30 seconds

- **Premise:** A stranger is trying to remove Abigail's recording while Frank remains missing and cleanup can begin if the crew is alerted.
- **Player objective:** Hear the tape, find Frank, and preserve enough independent evidence to prevent the file from being honestly dismissed as a drowning.
- **GM intent:** Human signal method, ordinary detective work, one synchronization gap, no campaign-scale proof.
- **Immediate stakes:** Original custody, fresh town memory, Frank's body, and an active machine record.
- **Starting decision:** What does Lilly protect or pursue when she cannot do everything at once?

Current situation

- **Table start:** RAY HOLTZ arrived at KCRK 102.3 FM at **8:45 a.m.** under a maintenance cover, seeking the original reel. ABIGAIL CARR refused to release it and is still delaying him when Lilly arrives later. CAL BRIGGS is at the inland compound off the lake road preparing Frank and the truck for movement, but he is not destroying records or wiping equipment. CHIEF WHITLEY shelved the file only hours ago.
- **If Ray leaves unchallenged:** he takes the reel only if it is surrendered, attempts to warn Cal, then heads toward escape or the compound.
- **If Lilly reaches the compound unalerted:** every evidence category is intact; she gets an observation/intervention beat before Cal detects police attention.
- **If Ray warns Cal or attention reaches the crew:** Cal enters the alerted state and starts active cleanup. The alert itself does not erase a category.
- **What has not happened yet:** Frank has not been moved; no prepared arrest, escape, official ruling, or evidence loss is history.

Pacing dashboard

Runtime point	Expected position	Optional cut if behind
Opening, first 10–15 min	Reel custody decision in SP1	Start with Ray's hand on the reel case
75–120 min	Two investigative vectors are active	Fold SP4 work order into SP2 or SP3
Climax window, final 60–90 min	SP5 compound reached from any route	Doyle supplies broad location after one evidence-cost step
Final 15–25 min	SP6 disposition	Resolve with evidence categories, one presentation roll maximum

FIVE-BEAT DASHBOARD

Beat	Story point(s)	Table cue
Explosive opening	SP1	Ray is taking evidence now.
Investigation and choices	SP2–SP4 in any order	Technical records, town notice, and access paper alter time and proof.
Escalation or reversal	Any alert, visible at SP5	The crew shifts to moving Frank and erasing originals.
Climactic set piece	SP5	Two Extras, wet compound, live equipment, cleanup clock, body/record preservation.
Consequences and closure	SP6	Evidence retained determines the defensible disposition.

3–4 hour core: keep SP1, SP2, SP5, and SP6; compress SP3 to Nancy plus Daisy's or West End Fuel

and fold SP4's work-order facts into that witness/records pass.

Climax situation

- **Location:** inland tower compound off Barrow Lake Rd (not KCRK); delivered in Story Point 5.
- **Opposition (Wild Cards / Extras):** Ray Holtz and Cal Briggs, both Extras; both complete profiles live in SP5.
- **Environment and interactive features:** wet concrete/metal, low light, chain-link, truck, outbuilding, breakers, live rack, fire/bin, two exits.
- **Urgency / countdown:** unalerted arrival begins with all categories intact and one observation/intervention beat. Once alerted, take one cleanup step after each round or substantial unopposed delay.
- **Secondary objective besides defeating everyone:** preserve Frank's body and/or an

- original signal record; arrest alone does not preserve either.
- **Situation payload:** speech, both complete Extra profiles, and rules live in Story Point 5.
 - **Boundary note:** this index adds no secret payload; SP5 holds the compound truth, and no result

SP 1

KCRK 102.3 FM: Tape in Motion

MOOD — READ THE ROOM

***Mood (table):** Cold rain beads on the studio glass and drips off coats stepping in from the street, into a cramped board crowded with reel boxes and a machine still warm from running. A stranger's shape leans over Abigail's desk. Low monitor music underlies spool hiss and a telephone receiver settling back into its cradle — an ordinary workroom, made abruptly proprietary.*

- **Goal:** decide custody and obtain a usable first reading of the recording without requiring any one choice.
- **Situation now:** **ABIGAIL CARR** wants the recording heard and her job protected. **RAY HOLTZ** arrived at **8:45 a.m.** under a maintenance cover and says he is collecting the original reel. Abigail refused it, so he remains when Lilly arrives

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise ★
Notice while the reel plays	The gap sounds like an awkward cut; Ray edges toward the reel while Abigail can still make a copy.	Lilly marks the cut and hears her surname inside police traffic after it.	She also sees the cut is too clean for ordinary damage and records counter 0418 immediately before it and 0419 immediately after. These locate the cut; they do not measure elapsed time.
Common Knowledge on Ray's cover	The form looks plausible; Ray leaves after one pointed question.	His language does not fit a local station service call.	The form lacks a station equipment ID and its callback is absent from the station directory.
Persuasion with Abigail	She refuses to surrender the original but permits a hurried cassette copy; trust cools.	She documents transfer of the original into Lilly's custody.	She adds the program log and confirms Ray arrived at 8:45 a.m.

- **Pressure/escalation:** Ray exits through the service door. If exposed, detained then released, or visibly tailed, he attempts to warn Cal. A successful warning starts the alerted state but does not itself erase a category.
- **Essential information and vectors:** the gap/traffic can come from this reel, Abigail/log, dispatch, timing log, optional mud cassette, or

identifies remote ownership.

- **If time is short:** if alerted, begin with the paper log already lost; if unalerted, keep all categories and compress the observation to one decision before detection. Run the remaining clock; do not replace the climax with an automatic arrest.
- **Spoken lines (Abigail):** *“I called because I wanted somebody to hear it, not because I wanted the tape walking out the door.”*
- **Spoken lines (Ray):** *“Station manager signs, I take it. Otherwise I write down that you refused service.”*
- **Spoken lines (Ray, if a tail is burned or Lilly confronts him):** *“You following me or arresting me? Pick one.”*
- **Handouts:** **Handout B** is on Abigail's desk from table start — give it when Lilly looks at Ray's paperwork. **Handout C** when Abigail supplies the program log (Persuasion raise, or she later brings it to the precinct).
- **Discoverable:**

later. He leaves within minutes if Lilly tests the cover.

compound gear. Ray can be tracked through witnesses, paperwork, or a tail.

- **Failure changes:** loss of original custody leaves a copy, testimony, logs, dispatch, timing evidence, compound evidence, and the optional cassette route. A burned tail reveals direction and alerts Cal without immediately erasing a category.
- **Reachable next points:** SP2 Records, SP3 Town Witnesses, SP4 Town Hall public works, or SP5 by

following Ray.

- **PC hook — Lilly:** Alertness adds +2 to Notice. Investigator adds +2 to Research and to Notice only when searching for clues/evidence in places or objects; listening to the reel normally uses Alertness only. Neither Edge is required.

GM ONLY — DO NOT READ ALOUD

GM Note: Ray wants the original and an exit, not a fight. He knows the technical job and staging, but Cal killed Frank. This studio is KCRK on Trapper Ridge; Frank is not here. Ray drove his own car here (slate-gray 1983 Datsun 810 Maxima, Oregon plate XLR 204); the shared out-of-county truck went with Cal to the lake road.

On the radio: 102.3 FM monitor — Stevie Nicks, “Talk to Me” (1985). Ordinary morning rotation makes the disputed silence feel procedural rather than prophetic.

× AT-HAND STATISTICS

Ray is an Extra. His one complete RUN profile is in SP5, where combat can occur; at the station he flees rather than fights.

§ AT-HAND RULES

Authority: HR-NFA-002; SWADE opposed Trait resolution remains authoritative. Quick reminder: An unnoticed tail uses Stealth/Driving vs Notice. Failure costs position and heat; it does not erase the route. Applied here: If Ray spots Lilly, he warns Cal. Lilly still gets his direction or warning location.

SP 2 Precinct Records: The Missing Interval

MOOD — READ THE ROOM

Mood (table): *Wet coats steam beside a humming radiator while a dispatch recorder turns beneath handwritten logs, grease-pencil marks, and evidence shelves crowding an open work surface. Recorder motors hum under clipped radio traffic, shifting paper, and the ordinary clicks of playback. It's patient, careful work — done under a roof that wants it finished fast.*

- **Goal:** compare independent records and determine what the “voice” actually contains.
- **Situation now:** SGT. DOYLE can provide dispatch access when Lilly presents a concrete reason. ABIGAIL CARR may bring a copy or log. Station and dispatch systems carry different ordinary content but both lose **9:14:00–9:15:52 p.m.** on the evening of session 1 — exactly **1 minute 52 seconds** — and police traffic after the

cut contains Lilly's name. **CHIEF WHITLEY** can impose time pressure but cannot make protected evidence cease to exist. Table default: the mud cassette Lilly found is bagged in the precinct property area with its seal/date fields incomplete, creating a custody seam but no retrieval gate. If the player explicitly remembers leaving it elsewhere, use a short Lake Barrow follow-up instead.

- **Spoken lines (Doyle):** *“Play the part before it. Then ours. Don't tell me what I'm supposed to hear.”*
- **Spoken lines (Abigail, if present):** *“That silence isn't dead air. I was in the chair.”*
- **Handouts:** **Handout D** when she has ordinary access to the dispatch reel. **Handout C** here if she did not get it at KCRK. **Handout G** only if she seeks the mud cassette; no transcript.
- **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise ★
Electronics comparing media	The tracks sound damaged; matching written start/stop times takes one hour and still establishes the overlap.	Lilly aligns the same 9:14:00–9:15:52 p.m. cut on two independent records.	She isolates the post-gap police bleed and identifies it as replay, not a live voice speaking to the station.
Research through logs	Cross-checking takes one hour; the matching blank remains visible.	Program, dispatch, and maintenance entries identify the same start and stop.	The typed sheet says “tower isolated 9:16 p.m.” while the key-board note says “tower key out 9:14 p.m. — C. Briggs,” placing Cal’s access inside the gap.
Notice (–2) on the mud cassette, only if retrieved	Handling creates a custody objection; the TDK SA C-60 still shows Ray’s mud-smudged sticker ALIGN CK — TWR 2.	Work tones and clipped police traffic match the station bleed.	Yellow leader splices bound the capture block; splice-to-splice playback is exactly 1 minute 52 seconds, independent of reel counters and paper clocks.

- **Pressure/escalation:** When either failed result costs an hour, advance cleanup once if active; if unalerted, Cal advances movement preparations but does not destroy a category. Whitley asks why a shelved file is using staff time.
- **Essential information and vectors:** station reel, dispatch recorder, maintenance timing, compound machine state, and the optional mud cassette can establish the gap/replay independently.
- **Failure changes:** alignment becomes less precise, cassette retrieval costs time/custody, or another record must carry the revelation. The cassette is never mandatory.
- **Reachable next points:** SP3, SP4, SP5, or SP6 if Lilly closes with what she has.

GM ONLY — DO NOT READ ALOUD

GM Note: The synchronization gap proves common process only. It does not reveal ownership, motive, or a national actor. The gap is always exactly 1 minute 52 seconds — a fixed signature across every record and, per campaign lore, across every era. The voice from Frank’s car radio in session 1 was the same tower replay bleeding into the receiver; this explains the eerie event without adding a new phenomenon.

On the radio: Precinct desk radio — Whitney Houston, “How Will I Know” (1985). Bright rotation continues while the recorder exposes a mechanical seam.

§ AT-HAND RULES

Authority: HR-NFA-002, Hitting the Books (Deadlands Noir p.29 converted to SWADE Research); no setting module active. Quick reminder: use Research for extended record work; failure costs time, heat, or position rather than blocking the case. Applied here: either listed failed comparison can cost one hour; resolve its single clock consequence in SP2 Pressure/escalation, while written overlap and other media remain available. The cassette’s Notice (–2) reflects the mud-smudged label and incomplete custody handling, not a permanent skill penalty.

SP 3 Ashgrove: Two Outsiders

MOOD — READ THE ROOM

Mood (table): *Fine rain darkens Daisy’s awning and keeps the morning crowd indoors, under a Cinder Creek clock and pie cooling beneath its dome, in booths that remember who sat where. Cups clink, the register bell rings, and strangers get described by where they parked themselves. In a town this size, anonymity is measured in minutes.*

- **Goal:** use the town’s social memory to establish two men, the truck, their split, and the lake-road inland route.
- **Situation now:** **NANCY IVERSON** can identify the early shifts. **DAISY PELL** saw two unfamiliar men, a faded chrome-yellow utility truck with **LANE CO.** on the door, and Ray’s slate-gray 1983 Datsun 810 Maxima (Oregon XLR 204) outside during breakfast. **BUD ELLISON** fueled the truck at West End Fuel at **8:22 a.m.** Ray then drove

south toward KCRK; Cal took the truck toward Barrow Lake Rd, not 328 east through Lowater. **WALT KEARNEY** may be in his 7am booth (county marking, then he wants to stay retired). **DON HALVORSEN** or **ANDY FOYLE** may have seen the split. **HELEN LOMAN** can establish Frank's habits if Lilly seeks her; she is not Helen Broome of 14 Cedar.

- **Spoken lines (Nancy):** *“If they ate breakfast here, start with what they ordered.”*
- **Spoken lines (Daisy):** *“Didn't know either one. Knew the truck wasn't mill. That yellow one had Lane County on the door. Gray car out front wasn't from around here either.”*

- **Spoken lines (Bud):** *“Filled 'em. Diesel. They didn't take 328 toward Lowater.”*
- **Spoken lines (Walt, if present):** *“Lane County. Not mill, not sheriff. I'm retired.”*
- **Spoken lines (Helen, if consulted):** *“Frank took his boots off at home. He didn't walk cold mud barefoot for anybody.”*
- **Handouts: Handout F** on Notice success at West End Fuel, or when Bud produces the carbon. Fail still gets direction from Bud — do not require the slip.
- **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise ★
Persuasion with witnesses	Questions become gossip and may alert the crew; one witness still gives chrome-yellow and LANE CO.	Two independent witnesses establish the pair and their split.	The 8:22 a.m. fuel chit and remembered Oregon WNT 41_ (last character unread) narrow the lake-road utility access and truck.
Common Knowledge using Nancy's map	She gives three calls, costing thirty minutes.	She identifies Daisy's and West End Fuel as fresh witnesses.	She names Daisy Pell at the breakfast register, Bud Ellison on the fuel island, and Iverson's as secondhand only.
Notice at West End Fuel	The paper bin was cleared; Bud still identifies the direction.	A carbon dated 8:22 a.m. , pump 1, 12.4 gal diesel , scrawled YEL LANE / WNT 41 , records the Lane County truck — not Ray's gasoline Maxima.	The parking smear is orange-red clay with angular crushed-basalt chips, matching the inland utility shoulder, not the lake bank's gray organic silt with pine needles or KCRK's wet river gravel/asphalt fines.
Notice or Research on the car outside Daisy's	Someone recalls “a gray import,” nothing more specific.	Lilly gets Oregon plate XLR 204.	A Salem MVD callback through dispatch (one hour or overnight) traces it to Valley U-Drive, Eugene, cash-rented under Alan Vickers, a name matching no local ID.

- **Pressure/escalation:** each public question makes the outsiders a town story. If that attention reaches the crew, Cal becomes alerted; after alert, additional elapsed time can advance cleanup.
- **Essential information and vectors:** Nancy, Daisy, Walt (optional), West End Fuel clerk/slip, Ray's car and plate outside Daisy's, station workers, day patrol, and access-key records independently establish the pair and route.
- **Failure changes:** stealth and time are lost, but gossip itself produces a broad description and

direction.

- **Reachable next points:** SP2, SP4, SP5, SP6.
- **Optional / PC hook:** Helen's testimony is optional corroboration of staging and never sole proof. Walt is optional plate/county color and never a briefing.

GM ONLY — DO NOT READ ALOUD

GM Note: Nobody here knows the crew's technical purpose or remote employer. Ashgrove's smallness is evidence and pressure, not quaint flavor. Do not send her to Cinder Creek Lumber or the Rennicks for this night. Lowater gas is a time-cost miss.

On the radio: Daisy's radio — Dire Straits, “Walk of Life” (1985). Familiar motion sits under a town reconstructing who drove where.

§ AT-HAND RULES

Authority: core Persuasion/Common Knowledge/Notice; HR-NFA-002 Patter only if Lilly takes one reluctant person aside. Quick reminder: ordinary conversation needs no roll unless outcome is uncertain and consequential. Applied here: rolls measure precision, time, and whether questions alert the crew—not whether Ashgrove noticed strangers at all.

SP 4 Town Hall public works: Paper That Does Not Land

MOOD — READ THE ROOM

***Mood (table):** Damp paper curls near a space heater in a cramped mill-era room, a labeled key board and stamped dates lined up beside pencils and a telephone directory. Dialing, file drawers, radiator ticks, and precinct noise through the wall fill the small office's quiet. It's a room protecting its routine, not expecting to be questioned.*

- **Goal:** establish paper-covered tower access while preserving the ownership boundary.
- **Situation now:** a **PUBLIC-WORKS CLERK** can explain normal procedure in the same Town Hall as PD. Ray's **Water Authority** work order names site **T-2**, vague continuity maintenance, Eugene callback **(503) 687-4419**, and billing **P.O. Box 2144, Eugene, OR 97401**. The key register records **9:14**

p.m., C. Briggs, key **TWR-2 / lake rd**, vehicle **YEL LANE / WNT 41**. Ashgrove has no Water Authority; Rookton Public Works is a 22-mile call and does not own this job.

- **Spoken lines (clerk):** “*We don't have a Water Authority. Keys for the creek and hydrants go on this board. Continuity isn't a valve.*”
- **Spoken lines (RAY HOLTZ, if detained and asked):** “*The number was on my sheet. That's all the office gave me.*”
- **Handouts:** **Handout E** when the clerk shows the key board or Research finds the line. **Handout B** if she never took Ray's sheet at KCRK. No printed 9:16 isolation sheet — speak that conflict if she earns the Research raise.
- **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise ★
Research through paper	Calling (503) 687-4419 reaches “Continuity desk. Leave a number” and dead-ends after an hour; no return tonight. If alerted, cleanup advances; if unalerted, only movement preparation advances. The signed 9:14 line remains.	Lilly links site T-2 , the TWR-2 key, YEL LANE / WNT 41 , and the chrome-yellow Lane County truck.	She also finds the precise interval penciled in a timing field; typed 9:16 p.m. isolation conflicts with handwritten 9:14 p.m. key-out.
Persuasion with the clerk	The clerk gives only normal procedure.	The clerk states “continuity maintenance” is not locally meaningful and the letterhead is not theirs.	The clerk provides the key sign-out and remembers Cal, not Ray, collected it.
Common Knowledge on callback/box	They look like ordinary remote administration.	Directory assistance has no Eugene Water Authority; neither number nor box resolves to a local operating company.	The form body is an older purple ditto; CALLBACK / BILL TO and their values are later black electric-type additions, slightly misaligned.

- **Pressure/escalation:** formal calls create a trace. If it reaches Ray or Cal, Cal becomes alerted; after alert, additional elapsed time can advance cleanup.
- **Essential information and vectors:** work order, clerk procedure, key register, station service sheet, and West End Fuel truck paperwork establish access and inconsistency.
- **Failure changes:** ownership stays unresolved and time is lost; authorized access and the inapt description still stand.
- **Reachable next points:** SP2, SP3, SP5, SP6.

GM ONLY — DO NOT READ ALOUD

GM Note: Even on a raise, the callback and PO box remain muddy local paperwork. An Eugene follow-up can confirm the box is paid cash three months ahead and collected in person, but its renter's name is not released tonight. No result names or proves a larger organization.

On the radio: Clerk's portable radio — The Dream Academy, “Life in a Northern Town” (1985). Wintry distance colors the office without interpreting its forms.

§ AT-HAND RULES

Authority: HR-NFA-002 Hitting the Books; SWADE Research remains the Trait. Quick reminder: extended records work may cost time on failure but cannot turn a raise into information the documents do not contain. Applied here: the ownership boundary is factual, not a difficulty gate.

SP 5 Inland Tower Compound**MOOD — READ THE ROOM**

Mood (table): *Cold rain runs the length of the utility road and beads on exposed metal, past chain-link fencing and a gate, a low equipment shed, a parked truck, and an outbuilding set back beneath the tower under a single work light. Rain drums on metal, a generator holds an uneven note, and relays click somewhere inside the shed. This is the end of a service road — cold, exposed, and far from anyone who'd hear a shout.*

- **Goal:** find Frank and preserve physical and signal truth, rewarding an unalerted approach and applying the cleanup clock only after alert.
- **Situation now — unalerted:** the gate is closed, the chrome-yellow Lane County truck is parked and empty, and no smoke rises from the barrel or stove. **CAL BRIGGS** is inside the shed or outbuilding preparing Frank and the truck for movement; the paper machine log, active signal head, wrapped

body, and staging material are intact. **RAY HOLTZ** is present only if prior choices put him here. Lilly gets one observation/intervention beat before Cal detects police attention.

- **Situation now — alerted:** the gate stands open, smoke rises from the barrel or stove, and the truck runs while Cal carries loads between the outbuilding and truck and destroys records. Ray is present only if prior choices put him here. Each substantial unopposed delay or combat round advances one available cleanup step.
- **Spoken lines (Cal):** *“Badge stays outside. Turn around.”*
- **Spoken lines (Ray, if present):** *“Back away from the rack. You don't know what you're touching.”*
- **Handouts:** none prepared here. Do not invent a compound log prop. Papers she already holds stay on the table.
- **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise ★
Notice on approach	Lilly sees one threat before action; a dragging seam still leads to the outbuilding. If unalerted, Cal detects her after this observation.	She spots Cal, the body route, and the signal rack; if alerted, she identifies the active wipe.	She also spots either the cut chain-link flap on the timber side of the shed (opposite the gate) or the live orange generator feeder across the shed doorway, and, if unalerted, remains unnoticed through one immediate action.
Athletics crossing slick structure or securing the truck	Lilly is prone or out of position for one round; no automatic injury.	She reaches the body, truck, or cutoff before the next step.	She also reaches the far side without crossing the live feeder again, or disables movement without damaging evidence.
Electronics preserving the signal record	If alerted, wrong isolation permits the active-head loss; if unalerted, failed handling alerts Cal but leaves the head intact for the first cleanup step. Paper, body, copies, and prior evidence are unaffected.	Lilly secures the head or stops the active wipe and preserves one original signal record.	She also preserves the alignment generator's elapsed-time display, zeroed at last night's isolate/capture start and showing 0:01:52. If cleanup is active, this must happen before rack power is killed.
Fighting or Shooting	Resolve normally; opposition gains time toward destruction or escape.	Resolve normally.	Resolve normally; a combat raise does not automatically preserve evidence.

- **Pressure/escalation:** unalerted arrival begins with no category lost. Warning or detection is the single reversal and starts the clock without erasing a category. Once alerted, advance: (1) paper log destroyed; (2) signal head erased; (3) Frank loaded/truck starts; (4) crewmen with an open route escape. Skip prevented steps.
- **Essential information and vectors:** body/injuries, staging kit/footwear, truck residue, machine/log, mud cassette match, Ray's narrow account, and Cal's acts.
- **Failure changes:** each missed step costs one evidence category; protected evidence survives. Incapacitation brings delayed Doyle recovery and a degraded end state.
- **Reachable next points:** SP6; unworked SP2–SP4 remain available if time and custody permit.
- **PC hook — Lilly:** Danger Sense may matter when the compound becomes immediately threatening; adjudicate from the canonical sheet/core Edge, not as automatic foreknowledge.

GM ONLY — DO NOT READ ALOUD

GM Note: Frank is dead and wrapped in the outbuilding, with a visible head injury and blood on his collar; his dry boots are beside him. Cal blocked his exit, struck him with a heavy work flashlight, and did not get help. Ray witnessed the aftermath, not the blow, then helped stage the lake. Ray's work boots in the truck hold **gray lake silt and pine needles in the treads** and **orange-red clay on the uppers**; the bed holds more gray silt, a wet rope, and a lake-water-smelling bucket. This is a visual media comparison, not a session-1 print match. Ray may separate from Cal if shown Cal is leaving him responsible: he can describe the aftermath and machine job, but cannot honestly claim he saw the strike or identify the remote employer. The site is inland from Lake Barrow — not KCRK or the printed powerline easement. Neither man fights to the death.

On the radio: Compound monitoring receiver — ordinary local programming leaks beneath work tones; use no named track once action begins so the signal evidence owns the sound.

× **AT-HAND STATISTICS****CAL BRIGGS** – Extra

Attributes: Agility d6, Smarts d4, Spirit d6, Strength d8, Vigor d6

Skills: Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d4, Driving d6, Fighting d6, Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Stealth d4

Pace: 6; Parry: 5; Toughness: 5

Hindrances: none needed at table

Edges: none

Gear: work gloves, compound keys, rope, truck; unarmed attack Str

Special Abilities: none

Personality: blunt, controlling, focused on finishing movement/destruction

Authority: SWADE Fifth Printing (2023), pp.10–11, 87–88, 95, 202

RAY HOLTZ – Extra

Attributes: Agility d6, Smarts d8, Spirit d4, Strength d6, Vigor d6

Skills: Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Electronics d8, Fighting d4, Notice d6, Persuasion d4, Repair d6, Stealth d6

Pace: 6; Parry: 4; Toughness: 5

Hindrances: none needed at table

Edges: none

Gear: work jacket, service papers, tool bag, flashlight, portable radio; unarmed attack Str

Special Abilities: none

Personality: procedural when calm; at the compound keeps Lilly off the rack while looking for escape or surrender rather than attacking

Authority: SWADE Fifth Printing (2023), pp.10–11, 87–88, 95, 202

§ **AT-HAND RULES**

Authority: SWADE Fifth Printing (2023), p.29 Athletics; pp.87–88 and 95 Extras; p.102 Illumination; p.202 NPCs; no combat house-rule override. Quick reminder: one Wound incapacitates an Extra. Use actual illumination; Dark is –4 to affected attacks, Notice, and similar tasks with the listed visibility limit. Applied here: local flashlight/work light may create Dim zones. Failed wet-footing Athletics changes position, not automatic damage. Cal and Ray are unarmed. **RULE UNCLEAR – GM DECISION REQUIRED:** if a tool is used as an improvised weapon, no value is prepared; do not invent damage.

SP 6 Precinct: Disposition**MOOD — READ THE ROOM**

Mood (table): *Rain ticks against the precinct windows while Frank's thin file sits beside whatever Lilly actually managed to bring back. Recorder motors run down, paper turns, and Whitley's office door closes behind someone. The room holds the gap between knowing and proving — and tonight, that gap is what gets written down.*

- **Goal:** state the strongest honest disposition supported by surviving evidence.
- **Situation now:** **CHIEF WHITLEY** wants a defensible small answer. **SGT. DOYLE** supports concrete matches. **ABIGAIL CARR** wants her

station protected. **HELEN LOMAN** wants Frank not to disappear into wording.

- **Spoken lines (Whitley):** *“Give me what you can sign your name under.”*
- **Spoken lines (Doyle):** *“Body, tape, times. Keep it to what we have.”*
- **Spoken lines (Abigail, if present):** *“Put down when the reel ran. Don't put words in my mouth about why.”*
- **Spoken lines (Helen, if present):** *“Don't tell me the lake took him if you know it didn't.”*
- **Handouts:** she presents whatever **Handouts B–G** she actually collected. Do not add new paper here.
- **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise ★
Persuasion presenting the file	Whitley contests the conclusion but must retain listed evidence and statements.	He reopens Loman as suspicious death/homicide inquiry.	He signs immediate holds on station, dispatch, and the work-order/key-register originals.
Research assembling custody/times	One seam remains challengeable; the strongest independent pair stands.	Facts, inference, and custody are clearly separated.	The interval comparison survives Whitley's first reduction attempt.

- **Pressure/escalation:** delay strengthens convenience and escape, not secret proof.
- **Essential information and vectors:** body, independent recordings, witnesses/truck, access paper, equipment/log, crew custody/statements.
- **Failure changes:** official wording may remain contested; every protected original and honest contradiction remains in Lilly's custody/file.
- **Reachable next points:** end state and after-play recording only. Night 3 remains an unrelated action case months later.

GM ONLY — DO NOT READ ALOUD
GM Note: Do not introduce hidden-organization proof here. The file answers Frank, staging, local capture/replay, and the synchronization gap only as evidence permits.

On the radio: Precinct radio — Whitney Houston, “How Will I Know” (1985), if ordinary rotation is audible. It returns the room to daily life without answering the case.

§ AT-HAND RULES
Authority: core Persuasion and Research; HR-NFA-002 Social Conflict only if the GM deliberately runs a three-round held confrontation. Quick reminder: do not force a subsystem for a single report presentation. Applied here: evidence categories set the ceiling; a raise cannot restore destroyed evidence or reveal absent ownership.

Optional GM lookups

FINDING THE COMPOUND
Any one strong vector gives the lake-road utility access; two independent vectors give the correct compound

without a roll. One weak vector costs time or begins approach farther away. Do not send her to KCRK's lot or the east-side easement as the compound.

Vector	Broad route	Precise access
Ray	Followed direction away from the station	Unburned tail to the lake-road gate
Town	Truck left West End Fuel toward Barrow Lake Rd, not Lowater	Fuel time/partial plate plus road mud
Paper	Tower work order	Town Hall key register/access time
Technical	Maintenance note near gap	Cassette/timing association with TWR 2
Direct police work	Doyle remembers the possible tower across the water	Patrol check after delay; cleanup advances only if the crew is alerted

Precise turnoff: past **Barrow Bait & Tackle**, still short of lake parking, take the two-track climbing inland beside a leaning utility-orange survey stake stenciled **T-2** at a culvert of orange-red clay spoil. The public 1984 sheets do not mark it.

EVIDENCE CATEGORIES

Track categories, not a mandatory checklist:
Frank/body, station or authenticated copy, dispatch original/copy, timing/log, town witnesses/truck, access paper, compound machine/staging, crew custody/statement.
Independent categories make a stronger disposition; no category retroactively restores another.

Escalation and clocks

Only one major reversal exists: the crew changes to active body movement and erasure. These rows are

consequences of that reversal, not new twists.

Trigger/time	Situation and visible warning	Effect on objective
Unalerted approach reaches compound	Every category remains intact; cold fire/bin, idle wipe controls, Cal preparing body/truck	Observation/intervention beat before detection
Ray exposed, released, or burns a tail	He warns Cal; payphone/radio use and hurried departure	Alerted state begins; no category erased by the alert itself
Public town questions or formal callback reaches crew	Crew knows cover is failing; witness mentions another caller or truck movement	Alerted state begins; no category erased by the alert itself
SP2 failed Electronics or Research result costs one hour	Resolve the consequence in SP2 Pressure/escalation; Whitley asks about staff time and weather worsens	Apply SP2 Pressure once; this row adds no additional step
Each alerted compound round/substantial delay	Next available cleanup action resolves; fire, erasing head, truck movement, or open exit	Lose one category unless prevented
Lilly requests Doyle and waits	Support arrives; patrol engine/radio on the utility road alerts Cal	Alert starts; then one step may resolve by arrival time

Failure-forward reference

Likely failure	Immediate consequence	New pressure/opportunity	Main plot remains reachable through
Ray gets station original	Custody weakens	Follow him or authenticate copy/log	dispatch, optional cassette, Abigail, timing, compound
Tail is burned	Cal warned	Route/direction still learned	town witnesses, paper, direct patrol check
Records comparison fails	One hour lost	written overlap or another medium remains	any two independent records
Witnesses resist	gossip spreads	broad truck description emerges	fuel slip, patrol, key register, station staff
Callback/PO box dead-end	ownership unresolved	access inconsistency becomes clear	clerk, key log, truck, compound
Compound cleanup step succeeds	one category lost	remaining objectives become urgent	protected records and all other categories
Lilly is incapacitated	crew gains movement time	Doyle recovers site later	degraded body/site plus protected evidence
Whitley rejects conclusion	disposition contested	custody holds and contradictions remain	body, originals, witnesses, later review

PC spotlight and safety

- **Opening hard-removal risks and mitigation:** none; Ray flees rather than attacks.
- **Replacement/re-entry option:** no spare PC in this solo campaign. Before the climax, Doyle recovers Lilly and play resumes after treatment with the clock advanced. At the climax, incapacity produces a defined degraded ending.
- **Point after which consequences become fully lethal:** Lilly knowingly confronts Cal at SP5. In an

unalerted approach, detection and Cal's warning mark that transition; in an alerted approach, truck movement, smoke, and live equipment already telegraph it.

- **Spotlight hooks by PC:** Lilly's police authority shapes custody; Alertness/Investigator support evidence work; Electronics can preserve the signal original; Curious pushes the paper seam; Danger

Sense may warn of immediate compound danger. None is an essential single vector.

- **Safety:** Lines and Veils/check-in as used by the table. Likely content: concealed corpse, recent

homicide, drowning staging, institutional dismissal, threat to a solo PC. Keep body description clinical unless the player requests otherwise.

NPC quick reference

- **Abigail Carr** — established radio host; start pin SP1; speech in SP1/SP2; no contest or combat profile prepared.
- **Ray Holtz** — Extra; start pin SP1; complete block SP5; SP1 contains a pointer only.
- **Cal Briggs** — Extra; start pin SP5; full block SP5.
- **Helen Loman** — adventure-local civilian witness; optional SP3 and SP6; no contest/combat profile.
- **Sgt. Doyle** — established police Extra, not statted; SP2/SP6 and possible delayed support.
- **Chief Whitley** — established police Extra, not statted; pressure at SP2 and closure at SP6.
- **Nancy Iverson** — established civilian Extra, not statted; SP3 social-map role.
- **Daisy Pell** — established civilian Extra, not statted; SP3 breakfast witness.
- **Bud Ellison** — adventure-local civilian Extra, not statted; SP3 fuel witness and Handout F.
- **Walt Kearney** — established civilian Extra, not statted; optional SP3 at Daisy's ~7am.
- **Don Halvorsen / Andy Foyle** — established police Extras, not statted; optional SP3 day-patrol vectors.
- **Public-works clerk** — unnamed civilian; SP4, same Town Hall as PD.

Rules quick reference

- **Authority order:** HR-NFA-001/002 within scope, then SWADE Fifth Printing (2023). No setting module is active.
- **HR-NFA-001:** Lilly's canonical sheet uses 15 post-core skill points; it does not alter tonight's resolution.
- **HR-NFA-002:** optional Hitting the Books, Interrogations, Patter, and Tailing only. It does not activate Deadlands Noir as a setting and does not import old-edition skills.
- **Extras:** one Wound incapacitates (SWADE p.95). Ray and Cal are Extras, not enemy Wild Cards.
- **Illumination:** use SWADE p.102 when darkness materially affects a task; determine the local zone from actual light.
- **Do not import:** setting Fear, Magic, Harrowed, Noir Poverty, Blood & Guts, Gritty Damage, Knock-Out Blows, Second Wind, or Deadlands Noir Companion.
- **Weapons:** opposition has no firearm. Lilly's service pistol remains on her canonical sheet and must use the verified SWADE modern-firearms table if exact values are needed; do not invent them here.

Handouts index

Cut the investigation packet before play. Give only the piece Lilly obtains. Failures still yield testimony; paper is the raise, not the only door. Source: [handouts/investigation-evidence.md]

(handouts/investigation-evidence.md). Table print: handouts/print/investigation-evidence.pt.pdf.

ID	What it is	Used at
Handout A	Lilly's case notebook (session-start memory; not tonight's answers)	First 15 minutes / table start. Print: handouts/print/lilly-notebook.pt.pdf
Handout B	Water Authority work order (English-as-found)	SP1 desk; SP4 if she never took it
Handout C	KCRK program log	SP1 when Abigail supplies the log; SP2 if delayed
Handout D	Dispatch recorder log	SP2 ordinary police access
Handout E	Town Hall key-register strip	SP4 clerk or Research
Handout F	West End Fuel carbon slip	SP3 Notice success or Bud produces the pad
Handout G	TDK cassette face + optional property tag	SP2 only if she seeks the mud cassette

Campaign rules card is separate:

(../handouts/print/player-quick-ref.pt.pdf).

[../handouts/print/player-quick-ref.pt.pdf]

GM secrets

- Frank is dead in the inland outbuilding. Cal killed him during a confrontation.
- Ray ran capture/replay equipment and helped Cal stage the lake.
- Barefoot tracks and the mud cassette are staging leftovers; the cassette is work media. Its exact post-session-1 custody/location was not recorded. Final-run default: precinct property area with incomplete seal/date fields; honor an explicit player memory of another location.
- Lilly's name came from replayed local police traffic.
- Independent records share one precise synchronization gap.
- The work order allows access but does not resolve operating ownership. The letterhead says Water Authority; Ashgrove's key board is town public works in Town Hall.
- The inland compound sits off Barrow Lake Rd, not at KCRK and not on the printed powerline easement.
- GM-only campaign boundary: no player-facing evidence here names ClearWave, the consortium, the Concordance, or a national organization. Ray and Cal cannot supply that proof.
- Preparation is not history. Record only outcomes actually played.

End states

- **Full success:** Frank and an original signal record are preserved; the synchronized interval and local access trail are documented; both crewmen are contained or identified.
- **Costly success:** murder is provable, but one original is erased or one crewman escapes.
- **Partial success:** staging and the repeated gap are established while the body is moved or official disposition remains contested.
- **Failure:** the crew moves Frank and Whitley's drowning/missing-person narrative strengthens; Lilly retains every independent item she protected.
- **Unexpected resolution:** Ray turns on Cal, townspeople converge, or Lilly chooses evidence over arrest; count surviving evidence categories and keep ownership muddy.
- **Rewards / advancement:** award campaign advancement only under the table's normal SWADE cadence. Fictional reward is the strongest defensible Loman disposition, preserved evidence, and earned trust from relevant people.
- **Continuing hook:** the synchronization gap is a durable seam, but this case ends locally. Night 3 is an unrelated action case months later.
- **Consequences to record after play:** Frank/body status; Ray/Cal status; preserved originals/copies; exact official disposition;

Abigail/Helen/Doyle/Whitley reactions; whether Lilly established the gap.

Table checklist

- | | |
|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• [x] Runtime header matches ADVENTURE.md.• [x] Compile follows templates/adventure/SKELETON.md document order.• [x] QUALITY.md scores 108/120; coherence passed with logic summary.• [x] No inactive setting material is active.• [x] Notation is filled and followed.• [x] Prepared stats/rules cite active authority or mark uncertainty.• [x] Mechanics sit beside the situation where used.• [x] Every situation with speakers has quoted lines and every secret has a GM Note.• [x] Essential information has independent vectors.• [x] Failures change time, heat, custody, position, or evidence. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• [x] Early removal has mitigation and re-entry handling.• [x] First 15 minutes is an index checklist with live trouble and no speech/stats.• [x] One home per payload inside this file.• [x] Five-beat dashboard is not a visit order.• [x] Climax combines opposition, environment, urgency, and preservation objectives.• [x] Pacing cuts include a 3–4 hour core.• [x] End states provide complete local closure.• [x] GM-only information is clearly marked.• [x] No prepared event is written as though it occurred.• [x] Handouts index lists A–G; each investigation prop is named at the situation that uses it. |
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After play - do not treat as prep

Do not create a recap now. After the session, record only actual events, unresolved questions, rulings,	character changes, and reviewed canon candidates. Reconcile campaign continuity only after play.
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